

Database Functions (Self-Learning)

Q. What is a User-Defined Function (UDF) in SQL? Explain how functions differ from Stored Procedures regarding parameters, return values, and execution contexts.

> **Definition to Remember**

1. Creating and Calling Functions

Creation: Must declare the return type explicitly.

Calling: Functions return a value, so they are embedded inside SQL NOT called via `CALL`.

2. Parameters and Return Values

- **Parameters:** Functions only accept **IN** parameters (input only no OUT or INOUT).

3. Procedures vs Functions

Feature	Stored Procedure	User-Defined Function
Can be called via CALL	Yes	No
Can return multiple values	Yes	No
Can be used in SQL statements	No	Yes
Can be used in WHERE clause	No	Yes
Can be used in SELECT statement	No	Yes

> **Must-Write Points (for 10 marks)**

> **Quick Recall**

> `UD
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